# CUSTOMER SUCCESS STRATEGIES



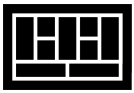
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SUPER GUIDE:

# CUSTOMER SUCCESS STRATEGIES

BY DANIEL PEREIRA



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# INTRODUCTION

If your only goal as a business owner is to maximize profits, you're setting yourself up for inevitable failures. Instead, your chances of expanding your firm in a way that generates more profits increase dramatically if you focus on providing real value to your customers. Companies with a habit of giving bad customer service will always be fighting an uphill battle to expand their operations. You can only gain return customers if they have had a positive experience with your firm the first time around.

Customers should never be taken for granted, which is why providing exceptional service is crucial to your company's success. Keeping up a continuous campaign of advertising aimed at bringing in new customers may be quite expensive, especially for smaller establishments. The difference between going out of business and staying in business for the long haul can be as simple as ensuring your customers feel appreciated and cared for.

You may ease the longer-term transition by sticking to the appropriate strategies and formalizing present efforts, even though launching a full-fledged program and team will likely necessitate a series of operational changes in the future. Then, when it's time for your organization to dive headfirst into such a program, you'll have already done a lot of the groundwork and be ready to roll it out to clients and reap the rewards.

Hold on a sec. Do just SaaS (software as a service) businesses need to worry about client success?

To put it briefly: no longer.

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For SaaS businesses, "customer success" is more than just a buzzword. As a matter of fact, a company's ability to retain customers and earn recurring revenue will improve by implementing a well-thought-out customer success strategy. But how do businesses come up with plans for success to make customers happier, get more people to use their products, and improve communication within the company?

Customer success originates in the rapidly expanding software as a service (SaaS) sector. Still, it presents a massive opportunity for businesses in industries unrelated to software to create compelling customer success programs that increase customer loyalty and repeat business. If you know about the inbound marketing method, you'll see how well these two projects go together immediately.

Finally, vital customer service is the actual driver of a fantastic customer experience, especially when your personnel goes above and beyond what is expected.

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# WHAT IS CUSTOMER SUCCESS?

The concept of customer success is widely regarded as the next big thing because of its potential to boost revenue and expansion.

To achieve customer success, you must anticipate problems or inquiries from customers and proactively address them. Improving customer satisfaction and retention rates can raise your business's income and client loyalty.

A firm can no longer rely on the quality of its products or services to grow and ground its position in the market in today's world of mass customers and competitive marketplaces, where innovative business competitors arise swiftly daily. What really makes a difference in the long-term success of a business is the impression your brand leaves on clients. In today's environment, a company's fortunes may be profoundly affected by the satisfaction with which customers employ your products. Businesses that want to succeed must constantly work to learn more about their customer's goals and needs to serve them better and help them succeed.

Nonetheless, you must complete the planning stage and start writing your customer success process. It's a complex task to roll out and refine a comprehensive and systematic customer success approach. Customer success managers need to clearly understand their motivations for wanting to aid their client's success, the value they will bring to their clients, and the best means of bringing that value to fruition. You should

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know that you can only help consumers in any capacity with a well-thought-out plan or strategy, especially if your role involves customer success or direct interaction with customers.

For this reason, there has been a lot of buzzes about "customer success strategy." There has been a massive change in the number of people looking for advice on creating a customer success plan.

The term "customer success" refers to maximizing profits by prioritizing client satisfaction. According to Gainsight, putting resources into obtaining new clients is a good use of time and money. Customer retention is crucial for SaaS businesses, and the key to doing so is ensuring that current clients are satisfied and productive. So, Gainsight does everything it can to ensure that SaaS customers get the promised business benefits.

Gainsight has developed a customer success management system that uses technology and big data to improve client retention, churn rate, and revenue. A few of the ways Gainsight guarantees its clients' satisfaction are outlined below.

1. Builds solid and long-lasting connections with clients;
2. Provides a fun and exciting experience for the customer;
3. Promotes satisfying customers over increasing profits by putting the spotlight on them;
4. Maintains a database of measures used for evaluating efficiency and productivity.

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# WHAT IS A CUSTOMER SUCCESS STRATEGY?

Companies do this critical thing to ensure their customers are happy with their products.

Furthermore, the management level of the customer success teams conducts activities or procedures to meet either the organization's long-term business goals or the customer success department's short-term goals. All future operations around achieving the department's or business's intended plans for the customer success process and its numerous integrated components should be focused on this broad, predetermined direction. Strategic planning is the systematic process that produces these strategies.

If the plan is successful, customer loss should be reduced, and upsell opportunities should rise.

It's important to remember that a customer success strategy involves:

- Coordinating the work of every team in the company;
- Not just the CSMs;
- Using all the available resources to help customers reach their goals by using your product or service.

A successful and realistic customer success strategy is all about integrating all the department's operations and utilizing and distributing all the available resources within the

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environment to satisfy the expectations and demands of the customers and help them reach their goals. A company must have a strategic planning process in place within its customer success department if it wants to ensure that all of its actions are working toward a shared objective and helping to achieve the goals that its customers have set for themselves.

A well-thought-out customer success plan is required to improve client retention, renewals, upselling, and cross-selling. All the customer success strategies listed above are meant to get clients to take action independently.

# CUSTOMER SUCCESS VS. CUSTOMER SUPPORT

There are two distinct but intertwined parts of any successful business: customer success and customer support. It is possible to make customers happy if you thoroughly understand customer success and support; therefore, let's explain them in layman's terms.

**Customer Success**
Proactively collaborating with consumers throughout your engagement to help them derive greater value from their purchases and provide constructive feedback is at the heart of customer success. It drives innovation in the user experience and guarantees a bright future.

However, several groups have heatedly debated the differences between these two concepts. All right, let's get this straightened out.

The customer support staff deals with problems with the service or product. This is an inherently reactive role. For instance, if a user is having trouble with the tool's

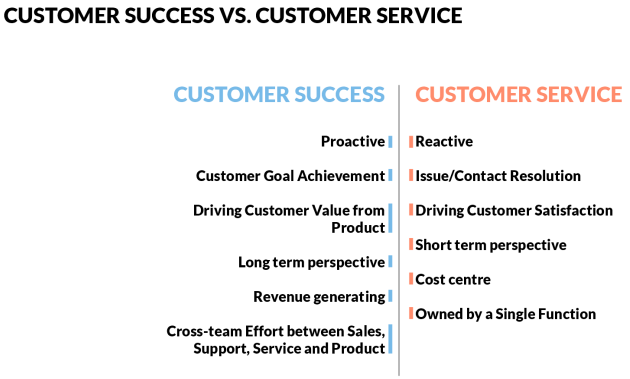
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customization options, they can reach out to customer support for assistance. Agents instruct customers on how to use the product effectively.

On the other hand, managers of customer success work proactively with customers to learn about their businesses and their personal reasons for using the service. They often initiate contact with customers by asking probing questions or offering to help. They also help with product uptake and onboarding for new users. Both groups work hard to give customers the best possible service. They both get the job done, but in their unique ways. This Venn diagram does a beautiful job of highlighting the differences.

**Customer Support**

The front lines of customer service are devoted to being responsive to customers via phone, email, live chat, and social media. Resolving customer complaints is the job of support, which is why it's a reactive function that's all about listening to and acting on individual requests.




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# CUSTOMER SUCCESS VS. ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT

Account management (AM) workers, like those in customer service and customer support, help people who ask for help. They deal with post-issue issues for a select group of loyal clients. These are typically large accounts with significant growth and expansion potential.

Account managers (AMs) view their clients' well-being through a financial lens, whereas customer success teams look at the big picture. As their job titles suggest, account managers are responsible for getting more clients and making more money.

Some customer success teams may emphasize revenue and recurring revenue (MRR), but this is rarely their main goal.

An account manager is a company professional who aims to keep and expand their customer base and sales. They build a good relationship with customers by answering questions and solving problems related to the company's products or services. This makes customers more likely to renew their service and buy more from the company. An account manager will put customer service first to bring in more money and help the company reach its goals.

Even though both the customer success manager and the account manager may work for the same company or even the same division, they do very different things. Among the distinguishing characteristics are the following:

**1. Average Pay**
According to reports, the average annual salary for customer success managers in the United States is $54,285. Your

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actual salary may depend on things you can't change, such as your level of education, your field of expertise, where you live, and the company you work for. According to a recent report by Indeed, the median annual salary for an account manager is $58,187, but they could make more money through sales commissions and other incentives.

**2. Constant and regular activities**

A customer success manager is responsible for both the business world and customer service. Many of their days are spent conversing with consumers and clients, where they field queries and address issues related to the company's wares and services. Helping customers with structural and process changes, like installation and implementation, is an important part of a customer success manager's job. Perform tasks such as troubleshooting, investigating, talking to individuals, and assisting consumers.

**3. Important future preparation**

A bachelor's degree in business or technology is usually required for jobs as a customer success manager. Numerous applicants have cross-trained in relevant communications, marketing, or management disciplines. Some companies hire customer success managers with formal training and experience in the same field as the products or services they sell. Some jobs at the top of a business may require a master's degree, a specialized certification, or a lot of relevant work experience.

Account managers usually need a bachelor's degree in a related field, such as business, public relations, or communications. Those with backgrounds in marketing, IT, or sales can also be successful in account management roles. Getting a master's degree in one of these areas improves a candidate's chances of getting a job. Depending on the business and the candidate's other qualifications, it may even be accepted in place of experience.

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# CUSTOMER SUCCESS

Managers of customer success use a wide range of customer service techniques to make sure their clients are happy. Customer success managers need to work well with others, think critically, communicate effectively, show empathy, and listen carefully. With these talents, the business can connect with the client and advise them on how to get the most out of their investment.

As a means of bringing in more cash and informing clients about sales, account managers need to learn and employ sales abilities. Networking, marketing, leadership, interpersonal communication, and sales are all common competencies among account managers. You may increase your company's revenue by selling more services to existing customers and winning over new ones with your newfound persuasion abilities.

**What Matters Here**

A customer success manager's primary role is to ensure that each client maximizes their investment in the business's offerings. Customer success strategies aim to increase the likelihood of contract renewals and repeat purchases from existing customers. A customer success manager's job is learning about and catering to their client's needs. You place a higher priority on measures like client retention and happiness than you do on things like new sales or revenue streams.

The account manager's primary responsibilities include increasing sales and generating revenue. They toil away at renewing contracts, upgrading services, and keeping clients loyal to the corporation in order to increase sales. The account manager typically has some sort of sales target in mind and will use all means necessary to achieve that target,

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including convincing clients to make a purchase. They focus more on the back end of the organization, where they manage and maintain client and earnings investments, rather than fielding direct inquiries from customers.

## CUSTOMER SUCCESS VS. CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE

Customer success is when a vendor and a customer work together to reach their full potential. Onboarding, kick-off conversations, cross-selling possibilities, and everything else that may be considered "business" in a customer relationship all come together to form the customer lifecycle. In short, customer success is a way to measure how successful and profitable a customer is throughout their relationship with a vendor.

Customer success managers (CSMs) make sure that an account stays "successful" over time. Many customer success managers (CSMs) have their performance tracked and judged based on key performance indicators (KPIs) like the number of new accounts, the number of customers who leave, their Net Promoter Score (NPS), and their calculated lifetime value. These are typically measurable, quantifiable outcomes that can be easily accounted for by executives.

## CUSTOMER'S EXPERIENCE

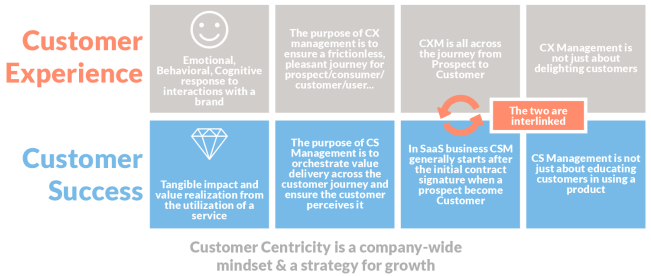
However, the customer experience requires a bit more thought. When figuring out how good a service is, what matters most is how influential customers and their representatives feel about it. The customer's experience is shaped by each and every engagement they have with the company, be it a discussion with marketing about a case

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study or a discussion with a CSM about an expansion opportunity.

Over the past few years, increasing customer success has become the most important goal for account management teams. Improving the customer experience has become the second most important goal. If a consumer has a fantastic experience, they will likely tell others about it, which can lead to account renewals and upsells. Even if customer success has come a long way, customer experience is just as crucial in today's era of customer engagement.

**COMPARING & CLARIFYING**




## How customer experience and customer success work together

Customer success and customer experience are two different but equally important parts of a business. However, they are tied together in many ways that are vital to the company's long-term survival.

Both the customer success and customer experience groups can contribute to the company's overall objectives of increasing revenue and strengthening client loyalty. They have common effects; happier clients are easier to upsell and cross-sell. Seventy-five percent of customers will pay more when they have a good experience with a company, as stated

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in the Zendesk Customer Experience Trends Report.

Other research has found that increasing the success of their customers leads to more repeat purchases.

An overwhelming majority of respondents in a survey by Gainsight agreed that implementing a customer success program would improve customer retention. The vast majority of respondents to the study agreed that boosting customer success also benefits the overall customer experience. Customer care teams enhance CX by showing customers how to get the most out of a product or service. As a result, customers are happier because they aren't forced to contact support workers as often.

When looking at the big picture, it becomes clear that two departments must work together to meet the client's needs.

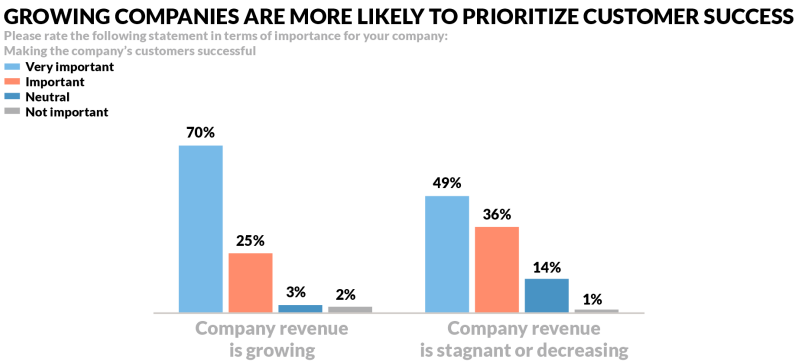
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# WHO NEEDS A CUSTOMER SUCCESS STRATEGY?

Already, customer success is a focus for some of today's fastest-growing and most promising startups. You need to put money into customer success if you have any clients.

Companies that are growing know that the best way to make money is to focus on how happy their customers are and how well their customers do.

The cost of customer acquisition has increased in recent years. That's why it's so important to take care of your current clientele; satisfied clients will promote your business for you.




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# WHY IS CUSTOMER SUCCESS IMPORTANT?

The growth of Software as a Service (SaaS) and other business models based on subscriptions has played a significant role in the development of customer success.

Instead of depending on the sale of significant, one-time discounts to customers, an increasing number of businesses are shifting to a strategy based on subscriptions. Items would be required to provide evidence of their value at the time of each renewal of the contract if this system were in place. Customers who believe they are getting consistent value and improvement from their product are more likely to renew their subscription. This is due to the fact that one can always choose to switch to a different kind of competition or product version at any given time.

However, it is in everyone's best interest to have satisfied customers, regardless of whether a company relies on a renewal or contract cycle. This is because happy customers bring in more revenue. According to the statistics, for every customer who calls for assistance, there are an additional 25 others who are experiencing the same problem but do not bother to contact anyone. The study also found that 91 percent of customers who do not file complaints will switch to a competitor if their concerns are not handled.

If your business puts a lot of effort into making sure its customers are happy by trying to predict and solve any problems that might come up, you can keep the other 26

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customers as clients.

When effectively implemented, customer success is a strategy that helps retain clients for more extended periods, stimulates repeat business, and increases income. In addition to the obvious financial benefits, a business strategy that focuses on the customer can also give useful information about how the product is used and what makes people buy it.

To keep from losing customers, a company needs to know a lot about its customers. Customer success is the way to do this.




# GOOD CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE INCREASES CUSTOMER LOYALTY FOR YOUR BRAND

According to a popular saying, repeat business comes from satisfied clients who will buy from you again.
The results of a customer impact survey conducted in 2011 revealed that 89% of consumers would stop buying from a

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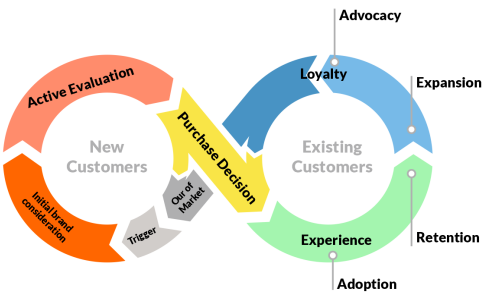
firm after experiencing even one unpleasant interaction. A similar study found that, if given the option, 86% of customers would pay an extra 25% for a superior customer service experience.

Because of globalization's virtually limitless options, the balance of power has shifted from corporations to individual consumers. Because of this, it will take a lot of work for businesses to keep their current position.

Their value is not solely based on price or product. A good experience is one of the top priorities for consumers, and it's high time brands recognized this early.

When experience takes the front seat, people are willing to pay more if they see that the brand cares about their experience with the product. This reduces churn and prevents customers from switching from your brand to competitors.

An excellent way to start developing your customer success program is to listen to your customers (survey, analyze feedback trends, monitor conversations) to find out what they need from your product. This could include features, pricing, the consumer journey, etc.




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# GREAT SERVICE REDUCES CUSTOMER CONFLICT

Eventually, every company will receive a customer complaint, but how you handle them makes you stand out from the crowd and beat out the competition. Customers respect those who are forthright when mistakes are made. Keep your cool if an unhappy customer gets hostile.

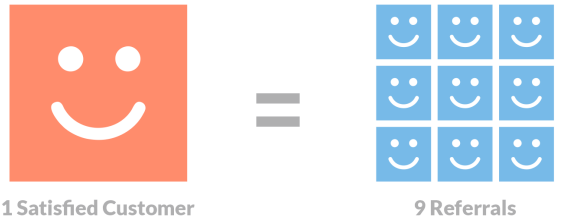
Respond and act professionally to prevent complaints from getting out of hand. Mindset, and avoid complaints from escalating.

# EXCELLENT CUSTOMER SERVICE HELPS CONVERT PROSPECTS

Exceptional customer service brings in new customers, and if you refuse to care for your customers, competitors will win them away from you.
The effectiveness of your customer service department can determine whether a potential buyer stays in your store and becomes a paying customer, or decides to leave before making a purchase. If you provide excellent service and foster pleasant connections with your clientele, they will be more likely to purchase from you again. Depending on your business, one happy customer can lead to as many as nine recommendations from others.

To what extent can you guarantee repeat business? More of your current customers can be retained if you focus on making them happy and satisfying their demands.

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# REDUCES EMPLOYEE TURNOVER

How your organization treats its clients will send a strong message to your staff. How can providing excellent customer service reduce business turnover rates? Your staff will feel more invested in their work and proud of their team when they witness pleasant interactions with customers and each other, including lighthearted banter.

If treating employees with dignity and respect is one of your company's core beliefs, you may expect a far higher retention rate.

# EXCELLENCE RAISES YOUR BRAND PROFILE

Customer excellence positively raises your brand profile. Delivering consistently excellent service to clients is a way to boost your brand's value. Free advertising, like positive word-of-mouth, can't be beaten. Your brand's reputation is more crucial than anything else when weighing the

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importance of customer service.

In order for a customer to feel comfortable purchasing from your company, a potential customer will think about or even investigate what others have said before they even get in touch with you. It's been estimated that 90% of consumers will listen to personal recommendations. Stop worrying about the bottom line and instead concentrate on creating a trustworthy brand.

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# CUSTOMER SUCCESS MANAGEMENT

Customer Success Management is the practice program tools required to help customers achieve all their desired business outcomes. Customer Success Management involves monitoring your business customer success representative and maintaining a customer service strategy.

Here are some of the responsibilities of a good customer success manager:

1. A customer service manager should devise a customer success strategy for continued customer engagement;
2. A customer service manager should be able to Recruit, train, and incentivize customer care agents in retention and attraction strategies, in addition to product knowledge;
3. A customer service manager should take charge of creating any further content and resources required by customer success representatives;
4. A customer service manager should solicit responses from customers using polls and questionnaires.

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# HOW DOES CUSTOMER SUCCESS WORK?

For a customer success service to work, three important factors must be considered:

1. Customer success solution;
2. Team and manager of customer success;
3. A customer success strategy.

# CHOOSE A CUSTOMER SUCCESS SOLUTION

Teams tasked with customer success must monitor every encounter with customers and compare it to key performance indicators and statistics like net promoter score (NPS) and customer health score. Customer success solutions (CRM) are what you need to reach this goal since they centralize and streamline customer input, communication, and action.

You need a customer success solution if you want satisfied consumers who will stick with your company, buy from you again, and refer you to their friends.

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# HIRE AND TRAIN A CUSTOMER SUCCESS TEAM

People in charge of customer success are managers and action-takers. They are accountable for directing the customer success function and bringing the plans and concepts to reality. The manager of a customer success team is responsible for coordinating the work of the team's members, who may come from a variety of backgrounds (communication, technology, and analytics), to achieve the company's overriding aim of customer satisfaction.

There must be somebody (or ideally multiple people) dedicated to ensuring the satisfaction of your customers. The size of your company will dictate how many reps and supervisors you need on your customer success team. As your business expands, you'll be in a better position to proactively help more customers.

# CREATE A CUSTOMER SUCCESS STRATEGY

You may better prepare your team for success by outlining the hows and whys of client success in advance. There is no universal formula for ensuring customer satisfaction. Your market presence, consumer base, and business model will all play a role.

Implementing a customer success strategy is crucial to the continued success of any firm. Here are the measures you should take when formulating a plan:

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- Determine the desired outcomes for your customers;
- Develop a plan to achieve those outcomes;
- Communicate that plan to your team;
- Put the plan into action.

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# WHY IS IT IMPORTANT TO DESIGN A CUSTOMER SUCCESS FRAMEWORK?

Focusing on customers' needs has become an integral part of daily operations in most SaaS companies. The foundation of a Customer Success framework is laid with the core elements of Customer Success in mind to guarantee productive procedures. Without a solid foundation, stability is impossible. Your Customer Success framework will fail regardless of whether you're missing a single piece or several.

**BENEFITS OF BUILDING YOUR CUSTOMER SUCCESS FRAMEWORK:**




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# CUSTOMER SUCCESS STRATEGIES

While the end goal of each business may be different, everyone in the marketing department can agree that achieving widespread customer success is crucial. However, if you want to achieve customer success while still keeping costs to a minimum and delighting your customers, you'll need to keep a few things in mind.

## BRAND AWARENESS

Often, the initial impression a potential customer has of your company will determine whether they choose to do business with you or not. For this reason, you must have a firm grasp of what qualities constitute an ideal client. Building a foundation for customer success begins with creating customer profiles.

To begin, you must determine the characteristics of an ideal client for your business. Simply put, who stands to gain from the partnership, and how, needs to be explained. In this way, the information you disseminate will be more relevant to the people you hope to reach.

## PRODUCT/SERVICE EDUCATION

A customer can like your content, but still not see the value in purchasing your service or product. The objective of this information is to increase the reader's trust in your brand. One way to accomplish this is for your organization to provide

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free material like blog posts and email newsletters that provide useful information about your business or industry. A more pleasant customer experience can be achieved by educating both potential leads and existing customers.

## CUSTOMER ACQUISITION

Your sales team is in command of the customer acquisition process. Everyone in your organization with whom a potential customer interacts must be "on the same page." This means that your marketing, sales, and operations departments should all be pulling in the same direction.

## GUIDED ONBOARDING

To a certain extent, the onboarding process is the most important part of every business-to-business organization. The chances of even the most carefully constructed strategies failing are incredibly high. The concluding stretch of the sales process is the ideal time for internal operations to become involved, easing the transition from acquisition to onboarding. It could be that changing a few minor aspects of your onboarding process would yield the best results.

## CUSTOMER SUPPORT

Customers will have more issues and queries as they continue to utilize your product or service. When customers run into problems, they should be able to reach out to your support team for assistance. If your support personnel can address customers' problems on the first try, you'll reduce customer defection by a large number.

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# VALUE REALIZATION

Now your clients understand what you've been trying to explain to them all along. To provide the best service possible, you must fully grasp the needs and wants of your customers. It's essential to have a customer success manager that follows up with clients regularly to ensure they're happy with the service they've received. That's a powerful tool for forging a strong connection with your customers.

# CUSTOMER LOYALTY

When a customer is loyal, they refuse to consider doing business with any of your company's rivals or competitors. Customers that have shown their loyalty are more likely to leave positive feedback, provide testimonials, and recommend your business to others. It's normal practice to make such a request of a satisfied consumer after a period during which loyalty has been formed.

# EXPANSION OFFERS

Offering expansion at the right time is essential. Working with a customer for a while allows you to gain a thorough comprehension of their needs. Discover the customer's level of interest in the material you're delivering them. If you want to run a profitable and successful business, making sure your customers are happy has to take up a significant portion of your time.

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# HOW TO CREATE A CUSTOMER SUCCESS STRATEGY

There are nine crucial elements of an effective customer success strategy. They are: understand your customer, develop processes, get a CRM, proactively educate, use automation, find your value realization moment, listen to what your customers say, be human, measure, and iterate.

## UNDERSTAND YOUR CUSTOMERS

Is your knowledge of the consumer deep? I don't get it; why are they buying from you? If they were to use the product, what would they hope to accomplish? There are a few things you can do to better understand your customers — and hence provide better service — including analyzing customer data and dividing your customers into distinct segments so that your sales and marketing teams may better target their efforts.

## DEVELOP PROCESSES

Knowing and valuing your target demographic should be a major aspect of any customer success plan. For instance, not all consumers require a customer success manager (CSM), therefore, you should examine your segments and begin thinking about the needs of each group.

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- How can one's tone become more serious in a conversation? Does it take longer for some clients than others?
- What kind of deals does your sales team work on, and how do they transfer them off to the success or support teams?
- What avenues of assistance or means of fulfillment are associated with which of your strategies?
- Does everyone have access to customer success?

Your internal and external teams will be better prepared for success if you make the creation of more streamlined processes a central aspect of your customer success plan.

## GET A CRM

To maintain order, use a customer relationship management (CRM) program. By using a customer relationship management system, your sales staff can keep track of the number of interactions they have made and the level of response they are receiving. Your support staff can have a more complete picture of the customer's situation.

Examples of CRM to consider includes:

- HubSpot
- Zoho CRM
- Pipedrive
- Salesforce

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# PROACTIVELY EDUCATE

One of the most important things you can do as a customer service manager is to assist your clients in any manner you can. Anything that helps consumers solve their issues before they contact you about it is considered proactive support.

Example of ways to do this includes webinars, documentation, case studies, social proofs, and support auto-responders.

The vast majority of individuals would like to never contact customer service, therefore, it makes sense to make it simple for them to receive the information they require. Give your consumers the information they need before they contact you for assistance. When it comes to proactively educating its clients on how to make the most of their products, you need an excellent budget.

# USE AUTOMATION

Scalable communications can be developed using the information and procedures outlined in the preceding sections of this essay. Send automated emails based on the customer's usage, product behavior, or stage in the customer lifecycle. Using automation, your CSMs and sales team will no longer have to second-guess whether they are communicating with the appropriate person at the appropriate time or not.

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# FIND YOUR VALUE REALIZATION MOMENT

At what point does the surprise occur for your customer when they realize the value of your product? There are probably several that combine to bring about satisfied customers. Your entire customer success approach should be geared at getting people to these points. Any action, from signing up a new client to launching a website, could fall into this category.

Your customer success plan should include creating content and processes that lead customers to these moments as soon and easily as feasible.

# LISTEN TO WHAT YOUR CUSTOMERS SAY

By breaking out your information in this way, you can see exactly where your customer effort and customer satisfaction ratings stand. There is likely to be yet another opening inside the first two months of a customer's trip if their experience is low at the beginning and improves dramatically beyond that point.

When requesting customer feedback, make sure you:

- Simplify the procedure for customers to contact you;
- Get back to customers directly on all correspondence;
- Automate the process of compiling feedback;
- To further understand the product's efficiency, inquire

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as to its intended usage.

Asking customers why they stopped using your product or service should be a part of your customer success plan. Getting exit feedback can teach you how to improve customer service and reduce client defection. To reduce revenue loss, it's essential to discuss the leading causes of customer defection and rank them in order of importance.

## BE HUMAN

Maintaining a human touch in customer service is essential. This necessitates staff members who give a damn about the company's customers. Look for characteristics like compassion, persistence, flexibility, and patience when making hires. Use language that sounds more like it was written by a person than a corporation.

## MEASURE AND ITERATE

Where do you stand with your consumers, and how are you faring yourself? You can't tell if your efforts are having an effect unless you frequently ask yourself and measure the indicators that lead up to these questions. To know if your customer success strategy is effective, you need to monitor its progress.

Some indicators to consider are as follows:

- Level of satisfaction of the Consumer Market
- Customer defection
- Development
- Retention

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For example, after launching a new component of your product, monitor these indicators to see whether they change, even if your product launch method hasn't changed.

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# CASES OF EXAMPLES OF CUSTOMER SUCCESS STRATEGY

Here are a few examples of Customer success strategy cases:

## FACEBOOK – PROACTIVE CUSTOMER SUPPORT

**Facebook makes it possible for users to assist themselves**
If you have any questions, you may find the answers you're looking for in Facebook's Help Center. The system's features are explained in detail in the help articles. Each time a new feature is added to the app, the previous one is updated to reflect the new information.

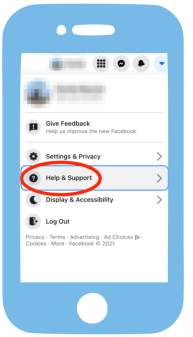
**Guided demonstrations of recently added functionality are provided**
It is common practice for the company to provide tours of newly released features so that users can get a feel for how they work and how they may best put them to use in their daily work.

**Users are given the freedom to report information on their own**
At times, Facebook users may encounter offensive or

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fabricated posts. The developers have included a "Report" button next to every post in the feed so that the user does not have to waste time looking for where to complain about the material.

**Provides informative newsletters through email**
Users of Facebook for Business pages can greatly benefit from this. As soon as you sign up, you will start getting periodic newsletters with tips on how to expand your idea and earn money from it on social media platforms like Facebook and Instagram.




# HELPCRUNCH – MAKE CUSTOMER ONBOARDING EASY

Ensuring a customer understands how to use your service or purchase is crucial after they've signed up for it. For the simple reason that there won't be any incentive for them to switch brands if they're finding success with it.

**The customer should be greeted with an email**

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A new client receives a welcome message and installation instructions after signing up for a free trial. It's crucial to keep in touch with customers right after they make a purchase or sign up.

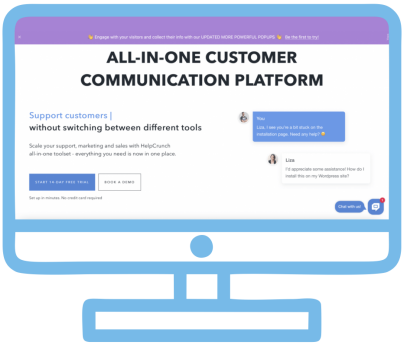
**Continue sending follow-up emails**
An additional email with a friendly reminder is sent to a new customer who has not yet completed the installation process. HelpCrunch has a full set of template emails that they share with beginners after they register. This is done so that they can effectively utilize the instrument for maximum benefit.

**Improve your data store by including how-to guides**
Users can get all the information they need to get the most out of the software on their own by searching the knowledge base. Topics include "How to set up an account?" and "How to install the HelpCrush widget on your website?" A tutorial that you can send to prospective customers would be a great idea as well.

**Make use of banners, pop-ups, and automated communications**
Users' initial experience with your community may not expose them to all the helpful functions it offers. Including automated messages is one way to direct people to useful features. It would be a good idea to put an advertising banner on your homepage so that interested parties may find out more about it.

**Offer Help With Orientation**
A small number of HelpCrush employees are customer success heroes; they are specialists who make significant contributions to the company's success by fostering client loyalty. They provide both emergency and preventative support for our customers at all times. Furthermore, their primary responsibility is to help our customers achieve their goals with the tools they've provided them.

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# HUBSPOT – CREATE FREE CONTENT TO EDUCATE YOUR CUSTOMERS

Confusion is very likely if your product or service is relatively advanced. Customers won't be able to take advantage of it to its fullest extent. Customers that have a bad experience with your business are less inclined to do business with you again.

HubSpot is fully capitalizing on the advantages that educational material may provide. Brands can now take advantage of their marketing, sales, and customer service platform that was developed in 2004 to facilitate the production of blog posts, e-books, and the distribution of such materials via social media.

HubSpot does anything and everything to inform its customers. This is done by:

**Making an in-depth blog post on the internet**
There are several helpful articles on their site on making content that readers will enjoy, share, and benefit from. Also, all resources about advertising and customer service. The

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objective is to provide as much detail as possible on the product, its uses, and its benefits.

**Establishing the HubSpot Academy**
Free online classes and seminars are implied by this resource for those in the fields of marketing, sales, and customer service. HubSpot Academy is a resource for learning how to utilize the HubSpot software for inbound marketing, sales, and business growth.

**Offering free access to a large collection of books**
The group is compiling e-books on over 40 different subjects in one central location. They cover everything from public relations and graphic design to customer service. There are lists, webinars, and quizzes included in the collection.

**A customer knowledge base makes it possible for customers to resolve their issues**
The corporation offers its customers a Help Center page, generally known as a knowledge base. Your most frequently asked questions are probably already answered there.




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# ZAPIER — SHARE CUSTOMER SUCCESS STORIES

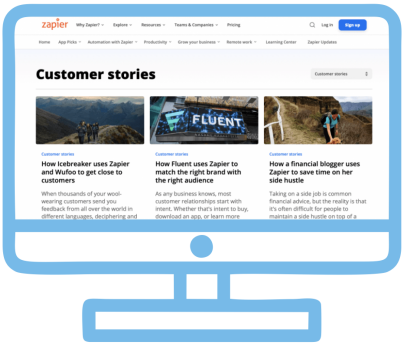
You should use narrative structure when writing a case study and aim to address the concerns, emotions, and needs of your target audience.

You may demonstrate the value of your product or service to potential customers and existing users by providing a case study. Explaining the good times that users have had will help new and potential customers know what to expect. An example of an organization that values customer case studies is Zapier. Zapier does this by:

**Sharing the tales of its satisfied clients**
The Why Zapier? tab on the homepage provides instant access to a drop-down menu featuring the Customer stories option. It will take you to a page with testimonials from many satisfied customers. There are many answers to many questions related to how the client benefitted from Zapier.

To show customers how your product may be used in other situations, it's a good idea to publish success stories on your social media.

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# HYATT — GATHER CUSTOMER FEEDBACK

There are three approaches to finding out if your product's users are getting the results they expect. The initial strategy involves making educated guesses. Questioning is the second. Third, witnessing customers defect from your brand.

Some of the main reasons for gathering customer feedback include boosting the percentage of returning customers and raising satisfaction among paying customers.

Hyatt Hotels Corporation gathers its feedback by:

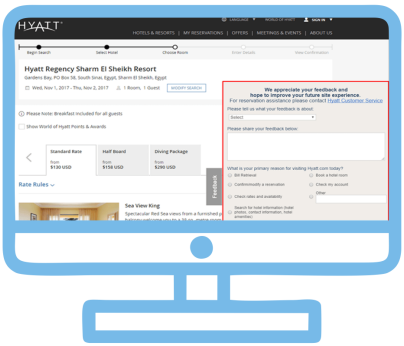
**Social media reviews**
Customers are encouraged to use one of two hashtags — #WorldOfHyatt and #WorldOfUnderstanding to discuss their hotel experiences on social media with the company. Hyatt benefits from the comments and attention of satisfied customers who post their photos. But tread carefully here, as a dissatisfied client can be bad for business, especially if he or she is a well-known celebrity or an influencer.

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**Provides feedback forms**

The hotel booking page includes a dedicated "provide feedback" button. When a user clicks on the link, a dialog box appears where they can provide comments regarding the company.

Involving many different teams across an organization, such as marketing, sales, and support, is essential when developing a customer success strategy. Taking appropriate steps at each juncture along the client journey is crucial to the strategy's success. You can increase customer loyalty and encourage repeat purchases by helping consumers achieve their goals with your product.




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# TIPS FOR ENABLING CUSTOMER SUCCESS

There are a few things you can do to aid your customer success, regardless of the size of your business.

## IMPLEMENT A CUSTOMER SUCCESS PROGRAM

To succeed in a company, you need a customer success plan, and yours must be tailored to your target audience. As your company expands, you'll need to adapt your plan accordingly. Because products and features are constantly developing, your needs and requirements will inevitably shift over time.

Whether your company has a dedicated customer success team or not, everyone must understand the importance of prioritizing the customer's success. Because information can be interpreted in a variety of ways depending on the team, it's important to adapt your communication to the specific group's needs.

## EDUCATE YOUR CUSTOMERS

Sales reps need to be prepared to answer the inevitable inquiries that will occur when customers use your items. Customers will appreciate not having to wait on hold while learning how to solve their problems before contacting you.

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You can do this in several ways, such as by providing in-depth product and feature explanations in a knowledge base or by offering real-time support via chat.

## ONBOARD CUSTOMERS

Customer onboarding is a fantastic opportunity to introduce your product to them and win them over. Customers' first impressions of your company are shaped by the onboarding process. Tutorials with clear, sequential steps, or direct help from sales representatives, are both examples of the types of resources that make up an onboarding program.

## COMMUNICATE WITH OTHER TEAMS

You can better assist your consumers if you keep the channels of communication open between the various divisions of your organization. Assist the marketing department in making blogs and videos that show how to use the product or feature. Communicate with the service team to coordinate your preventative and corrective measures, ensuring a uniformly professional experience for your consumers.

## PROMOTE CUSTOMER LOYALTY

Increasing your client retention rates may be accomplished in many ways, one of which is through the cultivation of brand supporters and promoters. You can do this in some ways, such as by instituting a point and discount system for repeat business from existing customers, or by developing a community for your current customers to communicate with each other.

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# COMMON REASONS WHY CUSTOMER SUCCESS FAIL

Here are some strategies that could help customer success managers avoid and recover from blunders.

## NOT PUTTING THE CUSTOMER FIRST

Customer Success Managers frequently pressure customers to take action before they are ready to do so. Putting the contract and money ahead of the customer's wishes, needs, and comfort level is a typical practice. Take a step back and make sure any choices made are in the best interests of the consumer.

## OVERDELIVERING

It's simple for Customer success management to try to force consumers into predetermined categories because they are creatures of habit. Customer retention and expansion hinge on a firm's ability to cater to each client's specific wants and help them achieve their desired results. This maintains customer and team member alertness, interest, and activity.

## SUCCESS IS NOT DEFINED

Process-oriented thinking is a common trap for Customer Success Managers to fall into. You get customers because you can help them with problems they have. Leaders in

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customer success must make sure they don't lose sight of these key performance indicators (KPIs) and final goals. If you fail to keep these objectives in mind, you risk losing this customer.

## FOCUSING ONLY ON REQUIRED OUTCOME

Customer Success Managers need to meet expectations while also addressing the concerns of specific accounts. The market is saturated with companies promising similar services at comparable prices, and consumers are well aware of this fact. When comparing several SaaS providers, the quality of their service to their end users is the deciding factor.

## CONFUSING HAPPINESS AND SUCCESS

Customer Success Managers need to keep a close eye on metrics and data that can reveal underlying problems. A Customer Success Manager may be able to salvage a relationship by fixing an issue that the client isn't even aware of. Like the general population, customers don't usually complain immediately when they encounter a problem.

## FORGETTING WE'RE WORKING WITH HUMANS

Connecting with as many people as you can inside your accounts can help you better serve your customers.

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Customer relationships are more valuable and lasting when you treat them like humans. There are a lot of things to divert your attention, such as signing up for multiple SaaS vendor accounts

## FOCUSING ONLY ON CHURN MITIGATION

It is not enough for leaders in customer success to simply patch up the systems when they see repeat customer attrition. If we want to make sure these kinds of problems don't come up again, we need to look at where our processes and procedures fall short.

## NOT HAVING A CUSTOMER SUCCESS CULTURE

The goal of every employee at a SaaS company should be to provide the greatest possible service to the company's clients. When all employees are working toward the same objective, additional key performance indicators (KPIs) can be simplified.

## FAILING TO PROPERLY MANAGE EXPECTATIONS

It's easy for Customer Success Managers to get into the habit of letting clients bully them. A customer relationship is not a one-way street, and both parties have responsibilities and rights. While Customer Success Managers are liable for

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delivering on agreed-upon goals and objectives, customers are also liable for keeping their end of the bargain.

## ACQUIRING BAD FIT CUSTOMERS

To enter into consumer connections without a chance of success is to doom all parties involved. Customer success managers need to coordinate closely with sales and upper management to decide when to terminate a customer relationship. This is a serious flaw that many SaaS companies have.

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# CONCLUSION

Growing pains, controlling costs, and finding new sources of revenue are just a few of the challenges that small businesses face daily. Marketing, brand reputation, sales, and income are just a few of the areas that might benefit from a focus on customer success. When you prioritize the happiness of your consumers, they will reward you by helping your company expand.

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